

CFO-RC FILE #: 1997-57COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS
SIGHT RECORD FORM

✓ 12-7-97 recd

(PHOTOS)

RESULTS: ACCEPTED 7-0

PLEASE PRINT OR TYPE. ATTACH PHOTOGRAPHS AND ADDITIONAL PAGES IF NECESSARY.

SPECIES: Anna's Hummingbird Calypte anna
(Common Name) (Scientific Name)DATE(S) OF OCCURRENCE: 12/5 12/6 12/10 1/1997NUMBER OF BIRDS SEEN: 1 SEX: Male PLUMAGE: adultEXACT LOCATION: residence in north Boulder Co (675 North Star Ct)COUNTY: Boulder NEAREST TOWN: in Boulder ELEVATION: 5,200 +LENGTH OF OBSERVATION: 1 hour or more TIME(S) OF OBSERVATION: 1215 1216
total 1:30 pm 9:30 am

OTHER OBSERVERS WHO SAW THE BIRD(S) WITH YOU:

Tony EspositoRobin & Banks Hudson(Elizabeth McKleson
she observed in hand)Elaine MeyersLeslie Larson

OTHER OBSERVERS WHO INDEPENDENTLY SAW THE BIRD(S):

Several at the Greenwood Wildlife Centerincluding members of the press

LIGHT CONDITIONS (QUALITY; DIRECTION RELATIVE TO BIRD(S); POSITION):

Partly cloudy and then in the sun

OPTICAL EQUIPMENT USED:

Nikon 9x25Vingmas10x26Tony'sDISTANCE FROM BIRD (ESTIMATED UNLESS OTHERWISE NOTED): 10 yards to in-handWAS BIRD PHOTOGRAPHED? yes but ^{see} enclosed IF SO, HAVE YOU SUBMITTED PHOTOS? WHO TOOK THE PHOTOGRAPHS? press

DESCRIBE THE GENERAL AND SPECIFIC HABITAT IN WHICH THE BIRD(S) OCCURRED:

a front yard that was enclosed by wooden fencehad trees and bushes and the nectar feeder

DESCRIBE THE BIRD'S BEHAVIOR (FLYING; FEEDING; HABITS; BEHAVIORS USED IN IDENTIFYING THE SPECIES OR IN SUPPORTING THE IDENTIFICATION):

Fly to and from feeder and perch on a limbwhere we watched & watched it.

DESCRIBE THE BIRD IN DETAIL. THIS IS THE MOST IMPORTANT PART OF THIS REPORT. INCLUDE THE OVERALL SIZE AND SHAPE AND HOW YOU PLACED THE BIRD IN THE GENERAL GROUP THAT YOU DID. GIVE COMPLETE DETAILS OF PLUMAGE, INCLUDING HEAD, THROAT, UNDERSIDES, NAPE, BACK, WINGS AND TAIL. GIVE PARTICULAR EMPHASIS TO MARKS YOU USED TO IDENTIFY THE BIRD(S). DESCRIBE OTHER DETAILS, SUCH AS COLOR AND SHAPE OF BILL, LEGS, EYE, ETC. THAT WERE IMPORTANT IN MAKING THE IDENTIFICATION. (FILL OUT THIS PORTION EVEN IF PHOTOGRAPHS ARE SUBMITTED; YOU MAY ATTACH ADDITIONAL SHEETS, DRAWINGS, FIELD SKETCHES OR COPY OF FIELD NOTES):

12/10 Tony + I did measurements on the bird

wing chord 49 mm tail length 31 mm. Body length app $3\frac{1}{2}$ " or more
weight 5.5 grams. Red on head and gorget - greenish back and
greenish gray breast
little white below gorget

on

Humming

12/13 This bird was flown to Tucson Arizona and given
to experts at the Sonora Desert Museum
they declared it an Anna's Hummingbird and when
released he promptly proceeded to court a nearby
female by flying a display flight. and has been feeding
at the museum's feeders

DISCUSS SIMILAR SPECIES AND HOW YOU ELIMINATED THEM:

Costa's color of plumage
color of head
and gorget

WHAT IS YOUR PRIOR EXPERIENCE WITH THIS AND SIMILARLY APPEARING SPECIES?

observed closely while
camping in Arizona

LIST BOOKS, GUIDES, RECORDINGS OR OTHER SOURCES CONSULTED AND HOW THIS INFLUENCED YOUR IDENTIFICATION (DURING AND AFTER OBSERVATION):

Golden Guide, National Geographic, Peterson
(consulted Bill Prather also)

THIS REPORT WAS MADE FROM NOTES MADE DURING partly - notes made
OBSERVATION, OR LATER FROM MEMORY OR AFTER

DATE OF WRITTEN REPORT: 12/7 and finished 12/16/97

REPORTING OBSERVER: Virginia Dionigi

SIGNATURE: Virginia Dionigi

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Pueblo, CO 81001

Mr. Rudolph P. Dionigi
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Longmont, CO 80503

1997-57

Hummer endures a bummer

Tiny bird survives 'Donner' ordeal

By Thomas Frank
Denver Post Staff Writer

SAT DEC 13
1997

As short as your index finger and as light as a paper clip, a hummingbird migrating from California was blown hundreds of miles off course, ending up dazed and disoriented in a Boulder backyard during the October blizzard.

There the warm-weather bird stayed for six weeks, feeding off the nectar Robin and Banks Hudson supplied every day and struggling to stay alive in frigid weather.

"For him, this was the Donner experience," said Anna Orgeron, a supervisor at Greenwood Wildlife Rehabilitation Sanctuary in Longmont.

The bird, known as an Anna's hummingbird, which is only rarely seen in Colorado, has regained its health at Greenwood's intensive-care unit, boost-



Special to The Denver Post / Patrick Kramer

'Rudolph,' a hummingbird blown off course while migrating from California, flutters atop his perch at Greenwood Rehabilitation Sanctuary in Longmont.

ing its weight back to a normal 5½ grams and awaiting an airplane flight this morning to Tucson.

"Rudolph," as he has been named by the Greenwood volunteers, will spend a few days acclimating at the Arizona-Sonora Desert Museum and then be

freed, possibly to join other Anna's hummingbirds living near the museum grounds.

"This is a really fragile animal," said Rachel Bellamy of Gilpin County, a

Please see **HUMMER** on 16A

Hummer to hitch a ride to Tucson

HUMMER from Page 1A

sanctuary volunteer who will fly Rudolph to Tucson using airline tickets she begged her brother to buy with his frequent-flier miles. Bellamy also got the airline, which she wouldn't name, to let her carry Rudolph wrapped in a basket inside a pet cage on board rather than place him in the baggage hold, where he would probably die from the cold and motion.

Bellamy rates Rudolph's chances of survival at excellent, which is miraculous considering the drama of his last two months.

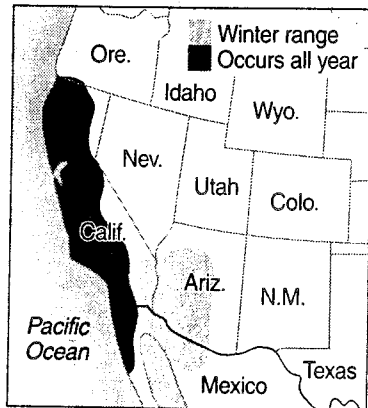
When Robin Hudson woke up the morning of Oct. 25 as a blizzard was dumping 2 feet of snow on Colorado, she was shocked to see a bright magenta-and-teal hummingbird buzzing around the frozen feeder hanging outside her second-floor bedroom. She quickly defrosted the feeder, filled it with sugar water and thought, "He'll go any minute."

But the bird didn't fly southwest, where he belongs. He stayed in the Hudson yard in North Boulder, feeding during the day and surviving the nighttime cold by reducing his bodily functions to a near-hibernation state of torpor.

When the Hudsons finally contacted the Greenwood sanctuary Dec. 4 and said there was a hummingbird in the yard, "they questioned my sanity," Robin Hudson recalled. But the next day, several volunteers and two "bird banders" arrived, armed with an 18-foot by 10-foot "mist net" that is so fine as to be nearly invisible.

Tony Esposito, a bird bander for

Normal range for Anna's hummingbird



Source: *Birds of North America* The Denver Post

27 years, stood under the feeder for an hour, but a breeze fluttered the net, enabling the bird to see and avoid it. The next day, Esposito's assistant Virginia Dionigi charged the bird with a small net, forcing him into Esposito's mist net.

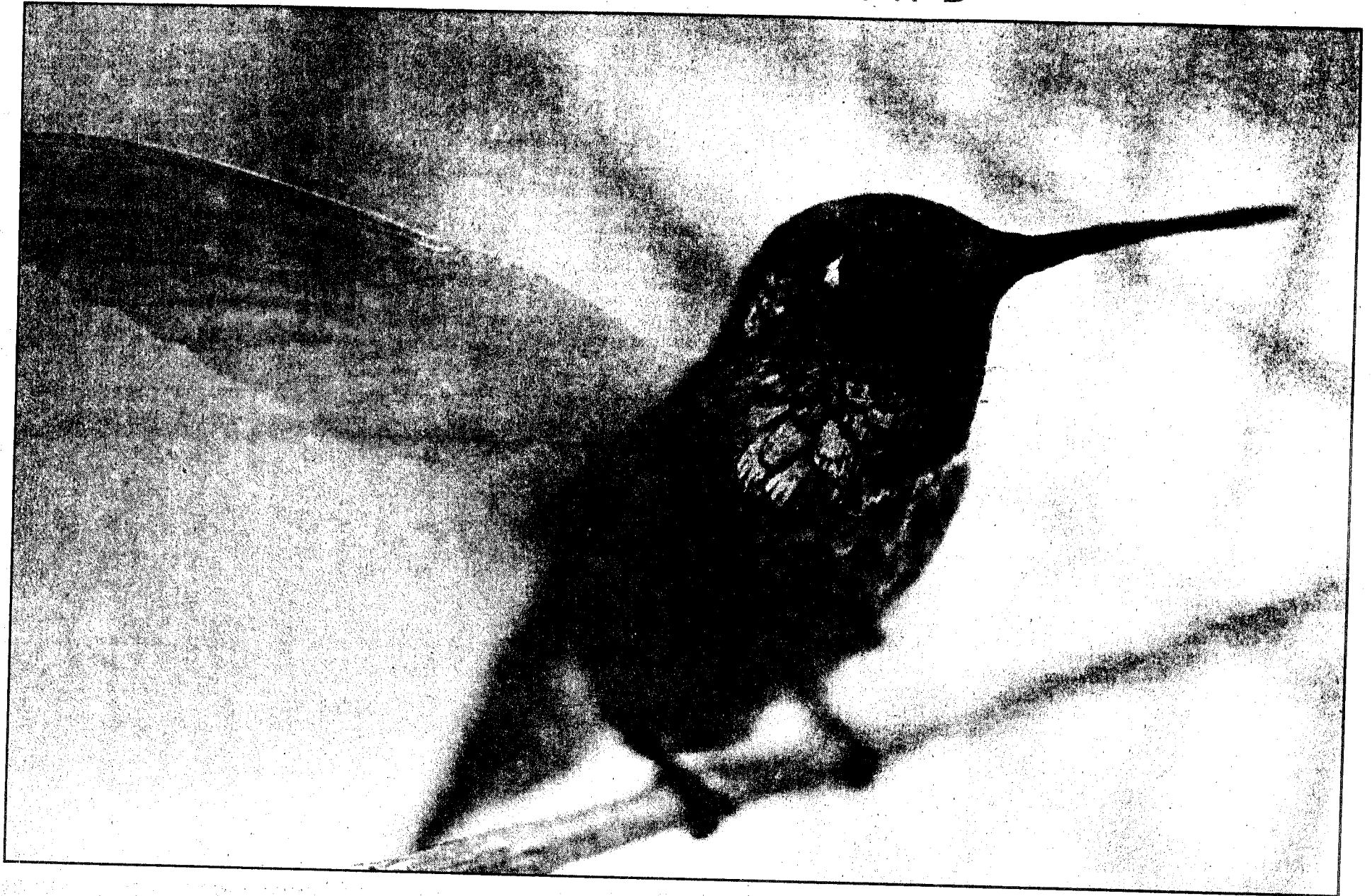
For the last week, Rudolph has been ensconced at Greenwood in an 18-inch by 10-inch plastic basket surrounded by netting to prevent him from flying and depleting his strength. He has been fed a special protein-filled nectar every day at 8 a.m. and 1 p.m. as volunteers record his condition.

For the staff at Greenwood, a three-room shelter that rehabilitates small orphaned and injured animals, saving Rudolph has been exciting and gratifying. But the real thrill will come in Arizona a few days from now when Rudolph is taken outside the museum, said Orgeron, the Greenwood supervisor.

"I can bet you the minute they open the door," she said, "he's out of there."

THE STORMBIRD

1997-57



This Anna's hummingbird flew into Boulder during the October snowstorm and is being cared for at the Greenwood Wildlife Rehabilitation Cen-

ter in Longmont until it is healthy enough to be sent to Arizona, where it would typically reside this time of year.

KIRK SPEER / Daily Camera

fly away HOME

A hummingbird

blown into Boulder

by El Niño

to be flown out by jet

By KATY HUMAN
Camera Staff Writer

They call him the El Niño hummer.

The little Anna's hummingbird blew into the Hudsons' back yard in Boulder's Wonderland Hills in late October, just after the blizzard that some people have attributed to the weather phenomenon El Niño. Anna's hummingbirds are rarely seen in Colorado, and certainly not at this time of year.

Now, the undernourished bird is recuperating at the Greenwood Wildlife Rehabilitation Center in Longmont, gaining weight and awaiting a trip south, to Tucson, Ariz., where others of his species spend the winter.

Robin Hudson said she and her husband couldn't believe it when they looked out their bedroom window in late October and saw a glimmer of movement around the hummingbird feeder, long neglected and dripping icicles.

When their first impressions proved true, they raced out, defrosted the feeder and put out fresh solution.

"We've been doing that every day now, thinking he was about to go," she said. But the tiny bird stuck around for nearly two months.

"Finally I called the Wild

"This little guy's
the most
gorgeous thing
I've ever seen."

— Rachel Bellamy

Bird Center. They said 'Are you sure you have a hummingbird?' like I was crazy," Hudson said. The retail store suggested the Greenwood Wildlife Rehabilitation Center, which responded quickly.

Last Friday, Greenwood pulled together a team of bird banders — people trained in setting up mist nets, presumably invisible to birds, to catch them and put identification bands on their legs.

The hummingbird — a male Anna's with a metallic green back and scarlet head — was entirely unfazed by the net.

"He immediately saw the net, went over it, flew down to the feeder, back over it and away again," laughed Elaine Myers, a shift supervisor at Greenwood.

The next morning, they tried again. Myers stood like a statue beneath the feeder, butterfly net in hand. She let the bird visit the feeder a couple of times before lunging after him

and trapping him between the butterfly net and the mist net.

Banders had the bird out within minutes.

Now he's tucked into a basket at Greenwood, putting on the grams with a high-energy solution of liquid protein and carbohydrate.

"I don't know how he maintained himself on sugar water," said Myers, who has been helping nourish the hummingbird back to health.

Native Colorado hummingbirds — broadtailed and rufous — leave the state by the end of September or early October, she explained. They fly south to warmer climes with more plentiful nectar.

Anna's hummingbirds are fairly common in the southeastern United States and California and other western states, but more rare in the central part of the country.

Pending the completion of complicated paperwork, the center hopes to fly the hummingbird to Arizona in the next week or two. They'll be happy to see him go, though it's been delightful having him at the Wildlife Rehabilitation Center.

"This little guy's the most gorgeous thing I've ever seen," said Rachel Bellamy, who works at Greenwood. "He's jeweled."